different templates, but the templates have many similarities. The example used throughout this chapter is based on a Visual Studio 2022 template, but you can easily follow along with templates from the .NET CLI or Visual Studio for Mac.

**NOTE** As a reminder, I use Visual Studio 2022 and ASP.NET Core with .NET 7 throughout the book.

Getting an application up and running locally typically involves four basic steps, which we'll work through in this chapter:

1. *Generate*—Create the base application from a template to get started.
2. *Restore*—Restore all the packages and dependencies to the local project folder using NuGet.
3. *Build*—Compile the application, and generate all the necessary artifacts.
4. *Run*—Run the compiled application.

Visual Studio and the .NET CLI include many ASP.NET Core templates for building different types of applications, such as

- *Minimal API applications*—HTTP API applications that return data in JSON format, which can be consumed by single-page applications (SPAs) and mobile apps. They're typically used in conjunction with client-side applications such as Angular and React.js or mobile applications.
- *Razor Pages web applications*—Razor Pages applications generate HTML on the server and are designed to be viewed by users in a web browser directly.
- *MVC applications*—MVC applications are similar to Razor Pages apps in that they generate HTML on the server and are designed to be viewed by users directly in a web browser. They use traditional MVC controllers instead of Razor Pages.